

PICKLING

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do we add vinegar with 5% acidity when pickling vegetables at home?

PICKLING

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To prevent harmful bacteria from growing and spoiling the pickles

FUN FACT

Adding enough vinegar makes pickles safe to eat by keeping bad bacteria away!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What happens if you reduce the amount of vinegar in a pickling recipe?

PICKLING

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ANSWER

The pickles might not be safe because harmful bacteria can grow

FUN FACT

Vinegar acidity must stay the same in recipes to keep pickles safe.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What type of container is best for fermenting pickles or sauerkraut at home?

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ANSWER

A food-grade crock, plastic, or glass container

FUN FACT

Using the right container keeps your pickles clean and tasty!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

How much salt do you need to add to 1 quart of water to make a proper brine for fermenting?

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ANSWER

About 11/2 tablespoons of salt

FUN FACT

Salt in brine helps good bacteria grow and keeps bad ones away!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

Why should you avoid using zinc, copper, or iron utensils when making pickles?

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ANSWER

They can react with the acid or salt and spoil the pickles

FUN FACT

Using safe utensils keeps your pickles delicious and safe to eat!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What is a 'fresh pack' pickle?

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ANSWER

Pickles where fresh vegetables are cooked briefly in brine or vinegar before canning

FUN FACT

Fresh pack pickles usually taste crisp and bright!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

Why do you cut off the blossom end of cucumbers before pickling?

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ANSWER

Because it contains enzymes that can make pickles soft

FUN FACT

Trimming cucumbers helps pickles stay crunchy longer!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

During cucumber fermentation, what keeps the vegetables under the brine?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

A weight like a plate with jars filled with water

FUN FACT

Keeping cucumbers underwater stops mold and helps good bacteria grow.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What happens if pickling salt is replaced with kosher or rock salt in a recipe?

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ANSWER

The pickling might fail because these salts have impurities or different density

FUN FACT

Using the correct salt keeps your pickles clear and tasty!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

Why do fermented pickles like sauerkraut take several weeks at room temperature to be ready?

PICKLING

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because good bacteria slowly make acid that preserves the vegetables

FUN FACT

Fermentation makes deliciously tangy flavors over time!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What is the purpose of removing air bubbles and adjusting headspace in pickling jars?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To help jars seal properly and prevent spoilage

FUN FACT

No air bubbles help keep your pickles safe and fresh!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What ingredients usually make up a quick pickle brine?

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ANSWER

Vinegar, water, salt, and sometimes sugar and spices

FUN FACT

Quick pickles use vinegar brine to make veggies tasty in a few days!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What is one way to make pickles extra firm before pickling?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Soak cucumbers in a lime water solution before pickling

FUN FACT

Lime water soaking helps cucumbers stay crisp and crunchy!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

Why is it important not to reuse two-piece metal canning lids for pickling jars?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because reused lids might not seal properly, causing spoilage

FUN FACT

New lids help your pickles stay fresh and safe!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

PICKLING

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Q

How long should jars of home canned pickles be stored before eating for best flavor?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

4 to 5 weeks to develop ideal flavor

FUN FACT

Waiting lets flavors get better and yummier!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

PICKLING

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Q

What happens during fermentation that helps preserve vegetables like sauerkraut or kimchi?

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ANSWER

Lactic acid bacteria grow and create acid that stops harmful bacteria

FUN FACT

Good bacteria naturally make acid to keep veggies safe and tasty!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

PICKLING

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Q

Why is it important to keep fermenting vegetables 1 to 2 inches under the brine surface?

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ANSWER

Because exposure to air can cause mold and spoilage

FUN FACT

Brine protects veggies from bad molds and keeps good bacteria alive.

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

PICKLING

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Q

Why should cucumbers used for pickling be fresh and used quickly after harvest?

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ANSWER

Because fresh cucumbers keep better quality and texture for pickles

FUN FACT

Early morning picked cucumbers make the best pickles!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

What is a reason to use crushed ice when preparing bread-and-butter pickles?

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ANSWER

The ice helps keep cucumbers crisp during the salting step

FUN FACT

Ice helps snap in those crunchy pickle bites!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs

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Q

Why is a boiling water canner used to process pickled vegetable jars?

PICKLING

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ANSWER

To heat jars enough to kill spoilage microorganisms and seal jars safely

FUN FACT

Boiling kills bad germs to keep your pickles safe to enjoy!

Source: NCHFP Pickled eggs